

NIGERIA — WEEKLY THREAT BRIEF

Nigerian Military Counter-Insurgency Operating Environment

Reporting period: 7 – 14 September 2026 (7 days) | Issued: Monday 14 September 2026. Three things changed the picture this week. First, a night infiltration attack on FOB Pulka in Gwoza on 7 September was repelled with the air component providing ISR and then striking the withdrawing force — multi-source. Second, The New Humanitarian reported on 7 September that a secret three-month ceasefire between the government and the Bakura Doro faction of Boko Haram/JAS has been in force since June and is expected to be extended; ISWAP is not party to it and the government has not commented. Third, the theatre we support changed commander: Maj Gen I. A. Ajose took over Operation HADIN KAI on 9 September. The visible air campaign returned, with a Lake Chad island interdiction at Tumbunma Baba and a five-aircraft package reported over Yankuzo in Zamfara. Background from the baseline assessment and earlier issues is not repeated.

1. Bottom Line Up Front

- FOB Pulka was attacked at night on 7 September and the air component fought the defence — ISR overhead, then precision strikes on the withdrawing party. Multi-source.** At about 22:00 on Monday 7 September suspected ISWAP fighters attempted to infiltrate the forward operating base at Pulka, Gwoza LGA, on the Mandara Mountains axis. Troops held; a reinforcement team from 26 Task Force Brigade Garrison mobilised; the OPHK air component provided ISR coverage and, as the attackers broke contact, struck them to disrupt the withdrawal. The official OPHK statement (Capt Mohammed Goni, 8 September) reports one soldier wounded in the left arm; the security report obtained by Zagazola gives one attacker killed, two soldiers wounded and evacuated to 7 Division hospital, and three MRAP tyres damaged. The casualty discrepancy is minor and typical of first reports. For our purposes this is the clearest recent example of the tasking pattern that will actually reach an air unit here: a night base-defence call, ISR first, then a strike on an enemy exfiltration route — with the enemy now on notice that withdrawing from a failed base attack draws air. Pulka is the same axis as the Ngoshe hostages and sits inside the area covered by the reported ceasefire below, which makes the ISWAP attribution worth noting: it is the excluded faction that is still attacking.
- A secret three-month ceasefire with Boko Haram/JAS has reportedly been in force since June — ISWAP is not part of it, and it changes the targeting question.** The New Humanitarian reported on 7 September, citing three people with contacts inside the group, that a truce between the government and the JAS leadership under Ibrahim Bakura Doro has held since June, is linked to the release of 360 Ngoshe hostages, reportedly involved a ₦5 billion payment the government denies, and is expected to be extended for a further 40 days. Communities around Ngoshe say attacks have stopped. The government, Defence Headquarters and the Army did not respond. Two of the same sources warned JAS may be using the truce to move 'equipment' into the Mandara mountains. Treat it as credible but unconfirmed: single-outlet reporting, widely republished (Premium Times, Pulse, allAfrica), no official acknowledgement. Three things follow for an air unit. Positive identification between JAS and ISWAP has just become a policy problem as well as a tactical one — if a no-strike understanding exists for Bakura-aligned groups in parts of the Mandara/Gwoza belt, it has not been published, and the crews flying there need to know whether one exists. The 'lull' reported around Ngoshe is political, not proof of military effect, and a cover for re-supply is exactly what the sources fear. And it re-reads last fortnight's picture: JAS-ISWAP clashes in Sambisa continue (TNH cites them as evidence the deal excludes ISWAP), OPHK's August surrender figure may partly reflect the truce, and the attacks that continue — Pulka, Kareto-Damasak, the Lake Chad axis — are ISWAP's.
- The visible air campaign returned: a Lake Chad island interdiction at Tumbunma Baba (~18 claimed killed) and a reported five-aircraft package over Yankuzo, Zamfara — plus Police Air Wing strikes in Katsina and Zamfara.** OPHK aircraft struck Tumbunma Baba in the Tumbuns at 06:05 on 11 September after confirmatory ISR on 9 September identified structures and logistics hubs during a reported high-profile meeting; military sources assess

about 18 killed and 85 per cent effect, and recommend further interdiction — single-chain (Zagazola, republished by Vanguard), casualty figure unverified. In the North West, local sources describe five military aircraft operating over Yankuzo, Tsafe LGA, on the evening of 7 September under Op FANSAN YAMMA, killing several fighters of the Ado Aleru network including a named lieutenant, Isiya Gurgu — unverified. Separately the Nigeria Police Air Wing reports sustained aerial operations around Karaduwa, Matazu, Dutsin-Ma, Dan Musa and Yankuzo in Katsina and the Jangebe axis of Zamfara: nine killed, camps destroyed, three PKM machine guns, three AK-47s and a rocket launcher with warheads recovered. Two readings: the ISR-to-strike cycle over the lake is running at about 48 hours and the Tumbuns are ISWAP's domain, outside any ceasefire; and at least three air operators are now working the same North West airspace — NAF under OPFY, Army/joint assets, and the Police Air Wing — which is a deconfliction question in its own right.

- **Command change in the theatre we support: Maj Gen I. A. Ajose is the new OPHK Theatre Commander (9 September), and a US C-17 delivered FMS equipment to the NAF at Lagos and Kainji.** The Army's 9 September repositioning moves Maj Gen I. A. Ajose from AHQ Department of Army Operations to Theatre Command JTF North East, replacing Maj Gen A. E. Abubakar, who goes to the Army Heritage and Future Centre. In the same list Brig Gen M. S. Sule takes 27 Task Force Brigade (the Biu formation that foiled the Buni Gari–Buratai ambush this week), Brig Gen I. Sule takes 6 Division Garrison in Port Harcourt, and Brig Gen M. S. Adamu commands a newly established 8 Brigade whose location the release does not state. Expect the usual changeover effects over the next month: a commander's battlefield circulation to FOBs (predictable, high-value movements that need air support), a review of standing tasking and strike authorities, and an early emphasis on visible results. Separately, AFRICOM announced on 10–11 September that a USAF C-17 delivered military equipment to the Nigerian Air Force at Lagos and Kainji under an existing foreign military sales case; Kainji is where the US advisory element and the reported MQ-9 presence sit, so the deconfliction picture there is unchanged but busier.
- **Fifteen weeks with nothing employed against aircraft — but MSR devices and direct fire on fuel tanks are the ground-side lessons, and Niamey purged its army chief.** No enemy drone use, no MANPADS, no GPS or EW interference and no aircraft or UAV losses, verified again by search this week; the Kadiya anti-aircraft rounds remain uncorroborated. What did happen: two command-detonated IEDs were initiated against a patrol on the Mairari–Gajiram main supply route on 5 September (no casualties, brigade garrison reinforced, enemy withdrew); a device was found and blown on the Damboa–Bulabulin–Maiduguri road; and in Sokoto simultaneous night attacks on FOB Tidibale and the village beside it (00:10, 6 September, Isa LGA) wounded one soldier and burned out two gun trucks after direct fire into their fuel tanks. Fuel-laden vehicles at a FOB under night attack burned; aircraft on a FOB pad or at a forward refuel point are the same target set. Regionally, Niger removed its armed forces chief Gen Moussa Salaou Barmou on 11 September, promoted Gen Mamane Sani Kiaou in his place, and made the Base 101 commander who stayed loyal during the mutiny deputy chief of staff — a regime-security reshuffle that will not improve cross-border coordination on the Nigeria–Niger seam. Mali lost the Dioura position in Mopti Region the same week.

2. North East Developments

Window note: the shape of the week changed again. The base attack returned (Pulka), the visible air campaign returned (Tumbunma Baba, Pulka), and the enemy's roadside campaign continued on the MSRs south and north of Maiduguri. Underneath all of it is the ceasefire report, which if accurate has been quietly shaping the theatre since June. The theatre's new commander inherits all three.

Pulka, 7 September — night infiltration attempt, air-supported defence

Detail as at Section 1. Two points worth extracting. First, this was an infiltration attempt rather than a mass assault — the security report describes an attempt to get inside the perimeter, not a Kadiya-style gun-truck attack — and the damage to three MRAP tyres suggests fire directed at the vehicles rather than the walls. Second, the official statement's emphasis on the air component (ISR for situational awareness, then strikes on 'hostile elements' attempting to escape) is a statement of doctrine as much as a report of events: a base under attack at night will get an ISR platform first and a strike on the exfil second. Crews should assume the enemy has drawn the same conclusion and will plan the withdrawal route with that in mind. Gwoza LGA has been the week's busiest axis for people coming out of the hills as well — see the escapes and surrenders below.

The reported ceasefire — who is in it, who is not, and what to ask

The New Humanitarian's account describes JAS as led by Ibrahim Bakura Doro from the islands of northern Lake Chad, with three subordinate factions that have sworn allegiance to him: the Ali Ngulde faction in the Mandara mountains (which carried out the Ngoshe kidnapping), Darul Gazwa under Alhai Kale in south-eastern Borno, and the Sadiku group in north-central Nigeria. The truce is said to have been negotiated through the Office of the National Security Adviser and the DSS, to have started in June with the Ngoshe release, and to be a likely candidate for a 40-day extension. Its stability depends on whether Bakura can hold the other three commanders to it; a previous armistice in 2022–23 collapsed. The security establishment's hoped-for end-state is described as 'do a deal with one, to fight the other' — an alignment with Bakura against ISWAP, which is the more lethal, better-funded and IS-Central-controlled adversary. For this brief the operational questions are concrete: which grid squares and which groups are covered; whether OPHK strike authorities have been adjusted; and how the theatre wants a JAS group observed moving in the Mandara belt handled. None of that is in open sources. The reported warning that JAS may be moving equipment into the Mandara mountains under the truce is the single most useful sentence in the piece for an ISR tasker.

Tumbunma Baba, 11 September — the lake interdiction

Detail as at Section 1. The timeline is the useful part: ISR on 9 September identified structures and logistics hubs, a reported high-profile meeting provided the trigger, and the strike went in at 06:05 on 11 September. The assessment of '85 per cent' with 'further air interdiction recommended' means a re-attack on the Tumbuns is likely inside the next fortnight. This is ISWAP territory and unaffected by any JAS truce. Note that no independent chain corroborates the 18 figure.

The MSRs — devices and ambushes

- **Mairari–Gajiram MSR, 5 September, 09:45.** A patrol with CJTF encountered two command-detonated IEDs at separate points; both were initiated as the troops approached, with no casualties, and the enemy was engaged from their firing positions until the brigade garrison, led by its commander, reinforced. Two devices, two locations, both command-initiated: a prepared engagement area on a supply route in northern Borno, not an opportunistic emplacement.
- **Damboa–Bulabulin–Maiduguri road.** Troops found and safely detonated an IED planted on the road in Damboa LGA (reported 8 September). Twenty-five Brigade separately arrested a suspected foreign national on the Azir–Damboa road.
- **Buni Gari–Buratai, Biu LGA.** 27 Task Force Brigade foiled an attempted Boko Haram ambush on the road and dismantled makeshift camps along the axis (reported 7–8 September). This is the formation that changes commander this week.

Mandara Mountains — the hills are leaking people

- **Escapes and rescues in Gwoza.** Two minors aged 14 and 10 who had been living with fighters escaped from an enclave in the Mandara Mountains and surrendered to troops; a woman and her daughter escaped a camp in the same range and were intercepted by 82 Division Task Force Battalion; eight abductees including several children were rescued in two operations on the Gwoza East corridor; four family members of fighters, including an eight-month-old infant, surrendered to 192 Battalion (Mechanised) on the Gwoza–Limankara road on 7 September; and a suspected ISWAP member with a gunshot wound was arrested loitering near a location referred to as Papa 7. Whether this is the effect of pressure, of the truce, or of hunger, the direction of travel is out of the hills.
- **A surrender through the Chadian Defence Forces.** 152 Task Force Battalion at Banki received a suspected terrorist who surrendered to Chadian forces and was handed across the border (reported 10 September) — a small but useful data point that the Chadian side of the seam is functioning as a channel.
- **Kaga.** A 20-year-old man who escaped after more than three months in captivity was intercepted by troops in Kaga LGA.

Counter-network fight — logistics, informants, cash

The week's arrests describe a supply system rather than a raiding party: two suspected collaborators with ₦3.65 million in cash in Monguno; a suspected ISWAP informant in Monguno with an identity card and drugs; three logistics suppliers in Konduga with food, household goods, bicycles and phones; two more with a large consignment of motorcycle spare parts (159 Battalion); a 22-year-old supplier and informant operating around Mada; a 20-year-old fighter who returned to Kukawa town after a year with groups on the Lake Chad axis; three drug peddlers with 92 parcels of cannabis hidden in television cartons on the Maiduguri–Mafa road; and, worth a second look, 233 Tank Battalion's interception of a vehicle carrying eleven empty CNG cylinders and an open-loop conversion kit without clearance. Pressure vessels and gas-conversion hardware moving without paperwork in this theatre are on the IED-precursor watch-list whether or not this case turns out to be commercial.

Adamawa

247 Reconnaissance Battalion intercepted a suspected logistics supplier with 64 rolls of clothing material at a stop-and-search point (reported 8 September), and troops arrested six members of a kidnapping syndicate operating in Song LGA, recovering a Dane gun (13 September). No new camp or contact reported on the Hong/Mandara-fringe axis this window.

Schools thread — day 122 and day 77

No release, negotiation or proof-of-life reporting surfaced this window for the Mussa pupils (taken 15 May) or the 36 Lassa students and one staff member (taken 29 June). The ceasefire reporting is notable for what it does not say: it links the truce to the Ngoshe release and to a payment, and makes no mention of the schoolchildren. If the truce is real and the Ali Ngulde faction is inside it, the Lassa cohort — taken from Askira-Uba, the same broad belt — is the obvious next test of what the arrangement buys.

3. Air / ISR & Force-Protection Watch Items

- **Night base-defence tasking is the live pattern.** Pulka shows the sequence: infiltration attempt around 22:00, ISR overhead, ground reinforcement, strike on the withdrawal. Plan for it — night ISR on call for the Gwoza/Mandara and Kukawa FOB belts, and a strike package that can be cued onto an exfil route rather than the base itself. Assume the enemy expects this and may site an ambush or a device on the route it wants you to think it is using.

- **The ceasefire is a targeting-policy question that nobody has answered publicly.** If a truce with Bakura-aligned JAS exists, the theatre has either adjusted strike authorities in the Mandara/Gwoza/Ngoshe belt or it has not; either answer matters to a crew asked to engage a group of armed men there. Ask through the chain; do not infer from the absence of guidance. Watch also for the 'equipment into the Mandara mountains' indicator: unusual pack-animal, motorcycle or foot traffic into the hills under a lull is precisely what an ISR platform on that axis should be looking for.
- **Lake Chad interdiction cycle: ISR on day one, strike on day three, re-attack likely.** Tumbunma Baba was found on 9 September and struck on 11 September; the assessment recommends further interdiction. Expect the Tumbuns to be re-attacked within the fortnight, and expect ISWAP to have moved what it could in the interval. Remember that ISWAP's bases have shelters and that the group is, by its own communities' account, 'only nervous about the air force bombing' — which is also an incentive to develop a counter.
- **North West airspace has at least three air operators in it.** NAF under Op FANSAN YAMMA (the five-aircraft package reported over Yankuzo on 7 September, if accurate, is a large one), Army and joint assets, and the Nigeria Police Air Wing running its own surveillance, troop insertion, air cover and interdiction missions across Katsina and Zamfara. Any of our tasking into the North West — or transits across it — needs the Police Air Wing in the deconfliction picture, not just the NAF. The rocket launcher with warheads recovered in Katsina is an RPG-class weapon and a standing low-level threat to rotary aircraft in the OPFY area.
- **Fuel on the ground is the target the enemy hit this week.** At FOB Tidibale two gun trucks burned out after direct fire into their fuel tanks during a night attack. The rotary-wing equivalent is a fuelled airframe on a FOB pad, a forward arming and refuelling point, or a bowser. Where we operate from or through austere FOBs at night, fuel dispersal, berming and the distance between the pad and the perimeter are worth a conversation with the ground commander.
- **Command changeover — expect movement, and expect a review of tasking.** A new theatre commander will circulate to sectors and FOBs early; those are predictable, announced VIP movements of the kind that drew the Kareto–Damasak convoy attack, and they will draw air-support tasking. Expect also a re-look at strike authorities, ISR priorities and the balance between the Lake Chad, Sambisa and Mandara axes, and an early appetite for demonstrable results. Note the 27 Task Force Brigade change at Bui and the new 6 Division Garrison commander in Port Harcourt if we route through either.
- **Threat systems: nothing employed — fifteen weeks.** No enemy drone use, no MANPADS, no GPS or EW interference, no aircraft or UAV losses. The last documented armed-drone use against a Nigerian base remains Sabon Gari, Damboa (late January 2026); the last confirmed airframe loss remains the 2 January CH-4 (technical failure, Kontagora). The Kadiya anti-aircraft rounds (29 August, single-source) remain uncorroborated — keep the indicator open. Standing background is unchanged: the February 2026 reporting of about 35 drones moved to ISWAP through the Lake Chad corridor, and ISWAP's demonstrated appetite for technology (ADF this month on AI-assisted attack planning).
- **US dimension — an FMS delivery, no new kinetic activity, and a political undertow.** AFRICOM's C-17 delivery to the NAF at Lagos and Kainji is the first visible US materiel movement in some weeks; DICON's Director General, Maj Gen Babatunde Alaya, appeared on an NDIA panel with AFRICOM leaders on 8–10 September. No new AFRICOM strike announcements. Standing posture for deconfliction purposes is unchanged (about 200 US personnel since 10 February 2026 at Maiduguri, Kainji and Bauchi; MQ-9 Reapers reported; a US–Nigeria fusion cell; Nigerian DHQ says the Americans are in non-combat roles). The undertow is that Washington is helping Abuja fight a group Abuja may be quietly in a truce with; if the ceasefire reporting hardens, expect it to surface in the congressional debate.

- **Regional airspace: Niger is reorganising for regime security, not for counter-terrorism.** Barmou out, Kiaou in as armed forces chief, Gen Abdourahmane Abou Zataka up to army chief of staff, and the Base 101 commander who held the airport base for the regime, Gen Ismael K. Sidi Omar, promoted to deputy chief of staff (RFI via Al Jazeera). Zagazola's analysis reads it as the first step of a wider loyalty-driven restructuring that will degrade the special-operations capability Barmou built and push JNIM/ISSP pressure toward Sokoto, Kebbi, Zamfara, Katsina, Jigawa and Yobe. Continue to assume unpredictable Nigerien airspace management and no functioning cross-border deconfliction. Mali's loss of Dioura (Téhenkou, Mopti) and the Sudan war's spill into Chad are the wider context: every neighbour on the northern arc is looking inward.
- **Information environment: the ceasefire story is itself the week's main information event.** Expect denial, counter-leak and political use of it as the 2027 campaign warms up — Senator Buba's counter-complaint over banditry allegations and the Army's denial that troops abducted clerics from Senator Yari's residence in Zamfara are the same phenomenon at state level. The operating rule stands: treat any loss, shoot-down, casualty or atrocity claim involving air assets as unverified until confirmed through the chain, and expect claims to be timed for political effect.

4. Other Theatres in Brief

- **North West — bases under night attack in Sokoto, air operations in Zamfara and Katsina, protest in Tambuwal.** Sokoto: simultaneous attacks on FOB Tidibale and Tidibale village at 00:10 on 6 September (Isa LGA) — one soldier wounded, two gun trucks burned out; 8 Division Garrison reinforcing FOB Ghandi engaged terrorists on the Gundumi road and recovered an AK-47; 8 Guards Task Force raided a Lakurawa motorcycle-repair workshop in Kware town and arrested a suspected informant at Denge Shuni; police reported several bandits killed in Tureta on 13 September. On 11 September displaced residents from Margai, Girkau, Romon Liman, Romon Sarki and Masu shut the Tambuwal–Jega and Tambuwal–Aleiro roads for several hours in protest at attacks and kidnappings, demanding more troops; one person was reported shot before police dispersed the crowd. Zamfara: the Yankuzo air operation (7 September); a terrorist killed in Shinkafi; 12 abductees rescued in Kaura Namoda and Tsafe and three more on the Anka–Gummi road; a logistics vehicle intercepted at FOB Sabon-Gari, Kaura Namoda; the Army denied on 14 September that troops abducted Islamic clerics from Senator Yari's residence. Katsina: Police Air Wing operations (Section 1); four victims rescued after a vehicle attack on the Ruwan Godiya axis, Faskari; a logistics supplier intercepted with four new motorcycles and 450 litres of petrol. Kaduna: JTF North West arrested a terrorist kingpin, an ammunition courier and a logistics supplier (10 September); more than 500 rustled cattle recovered in Igabi; a kidnapped couple rescued after a gun battle in Sanga; a farmer–herder clash contained in Kauru; a suspected drug vehicle seized in Birnin Gwari. MACBAN raised the alarm over alleged killings and displacement of pastoralists in Niger and Kebbi states.
- **North Central / Middle Belt — Plateau turned lethal again; Benue's Ayilamo attacked for a second time in a fortnight.** Plateau: on the night of Sunday 13 September gunmen opened fire on a vehicle carrying passengers to Jos at Dungus, Jos South, and attacked communities in Mangu and Riyom — Vanguard reports 13 killed including nine passengers; Premium Times reports four; a community advocate reports eight. Treat the total as unresolved but the vehicle attack as confirmed. Earlier in the week three Fulani herders were killed and between 36 and 50 cattle shot at Alohom, Sabon Gari district, Mangu (11–12 September), attributed to Mwaghavul militia; a man was shot at Rampiya, Mangu, on 13 September; Berom militia attacked herders on the Jong–Nyeriwei road and at Dorowa Babuje (9 September), prompting a visit by the GOC 3 Division, Maj Gen W. M. Dangana; a vigilante was killed on sentry duty at Kafi Abu, Barkin Ladi, and a 17-year-old at the same village (three arrested); a soldier was

wounded in a clearance firefight with local militia at Kogul, Mangu (10 September); kidnappers attacked a vehicle on the Jos–Makarfi highway in Riyom, wounding three and taking two; a kidnap attempt was foiled at the late Gen Bagudos' residence in Bassa; and the routine cattle interceptions, farm-destruction mediations, illegal-miner arrests and body recoveries continued at very high volume. Herders paid ₦4.5 million in compensation to 38 Bokkos farmers — one of the few de-escalatory items. Benue: on 10 September from about 18:12 suspected armed herders attacked Ayilamo, Logo LGA, for roughly seven hours; police confirm four mobile policemen and seven civilians killed (Zagazola's early figure of five is superseded). The DSS arrested three suspects and Governor Alia commended them. Ayilamo is the community where the state-level Operation Zenda was criticised over a clearance on 27 August. Elsewhere Op WHIRL STROKE rescued four victims in Katsina-Ala and arrested robbers in Guma; 12 Brigade arrested two suspects over an attack on farmers in Adavi, Kogi; 177 Guards Battalion at FOB Mararaba Udege, Nasarawa, intercepted a suspected child trafficker. Peter Obi's visit to Benue was disrupted, which NDC and Sowore protested — campaign-season friction.

- **South East — a quiet week in reporting; levels hold.** No IED, camp raid or contact was reported inside the window in Anambra, Imo, Abia, Enugu or Ebonyi; Imo and Anambra hold 3 on the August–early-September pattern. A widely surfaced NAN item on NAF strikes against IPOB/ESN hideouts at Mother Valley and Aku Ihube is from September 2023 and was excluded.
- **Niger Delta / Gulf of Guinea — fourteenth consecutive quiet week for militancy; the 83 Division question moves.** No new pipeline or maritime attack claims. 90 Amphibious Battalion with the NDLEA arrested five drug peddlers in Sapele; 2 Brigade Garrison arrested five fuel thieves at HITECH 1 on the Uyo–Oron road (6 September, edge of window); a Nigerian Navy lieutenant from NNS Ogun was arrested with 248 moulds of cannabis in Rivers on 7 September. An Army Headquarters committee visited 63 Brigade in Asaba and the traditional rulers of Ebu and Akwukwu-Igbo on 7 September to inspect two proposed sites for units of the new 83 Division — see Annex A for the correction to where that division actually stands.
- **South West and Edo — Edo is the one heatmap level change this week.** Three separate kidnap-related actions in Edo inside one week: 4 Brigade under Op WHIRL PUNCH / Op RESCUE arrested a kidnapper with an AK-47 in Ikpoba-Okha; Op MESA raided a kidnappers' hideout in the Ogori Mangogo/Imorga forest, Akoko-Edo; and 322 Army Regiment with police and vigilantes rescued a victim at Ekpoma. Edo goes 1 → 2. Elsewhere: 2 Division Garrison arrested two kidnappers in Orire, Oyo; 65 Battalion rescued two farmers and killed a suspect at Igbonla, Epe (6 September); in Osun, Governor Adeleke banned NURTW activity on 14 September after a political ally was shot dead — political violence to watch in the South West as the cycle warms.
- **Regional and political weather.** Niger's command reshuffle (Sections 1 and 3); Mali's loss of Dioura; Zagazola's analysis that the Sudan war is spilling into Chad and that Nigeria is now the buffer on the eastern arc — relevant to how much attention Chad's MNJTF sector will get. Domestically: an investigation opened into the death of a senior NCO after a shooting at Kuje custodial centre in the FCT; the Correctional Service and Army Intelligence agreed to deepen custodial-security cooperation; the federal government began operationalising 112 as the national emergency number. No gubernatorial changes this week.

5. Country Activity Heatmap (last 3 months)

The two views below summarise assessed security activity across all 36 states and the FCT over roughly the last three months (≈ mid June – 14 September 2026). The choropleth shows each state's dominant incident type (fill colour) and intensity (shade depth and number); the matrix breaks activity down by incident type. This is an indicative qualitative assessment for orientation —

synthesised from open-source reporting, not a counted event dataset such as ACLED. ONE level change this issue: Edo 1 → 2, dominant type none → banditry/kidnapping, on three separate kidnap-related military actions in one week — the Ikpoba-Okha AK-47 arrest, the Akoko-Edo forest hideout raid and the Ekpoma rescue — which together read as a sustained forest-based kidnap pattern on the Edo–Kogi–Ondo seam rather than one-off crime. Everything else holds. Borno holds 4, reinforced (Pulka base attack 7 September, Tumbunma Baba interdiction 11 September, two command-detonated IEDs on the Mairari–Gajiram MSR, the Damboa–Bulabulin device, the Buni Gari–Buratai ambush, and the reported JAS ceasefire). Plateau holds 4 but is more lethal than last week (13 September night attacks, the Alohom herder killings, the Kogul firefight). Benue holds 4, reinforced (Ayilamo, 11 killed including four police). Sokoto holds 4, reinforced (FOB Tidibale attack, Tambuwal protest). Zamfara and Katsina hold 4 on the air operations and rescues; Kaduna holds 3 on the kingpin and courier arrests. Adamawa 3, Niger 4, Kebbi 3, Kogi 3, Anambra 3, Imo 3 (no new South East device), Kwara 2, Delta 2 (fourteenth quiet militancy week), Yobe 2, Jigawa 1 and Osun 1 all hold. Noted but not levelled: Oyo (Orire kidnap arrests), Nasarawa (child-trafficking arrest), FCT (Kuje custodial shooting) and Rivers (naval officer drug arrest) — internal-discipline and single-week items insufficient for a three-month qualitative change.

Nigeria Activity Heatmap — Geographic View (assessed, last ~3 months)
Indicative qualitative assessment as of 2026-09-14 — not a counted incident dataset

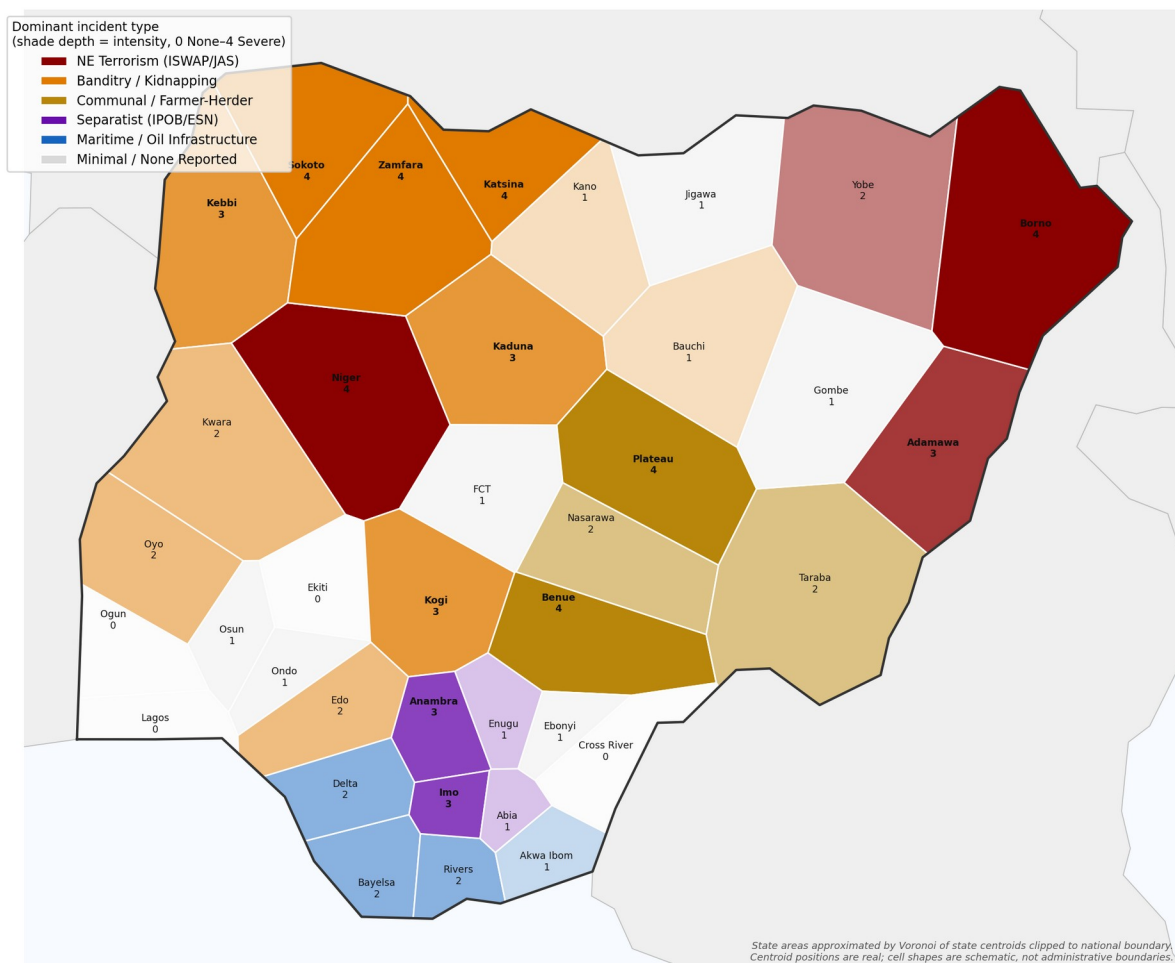


Figure 1 — Activity choropleth on a Natural Earth basemap (Nigeria + neighbours). Fill = dominant incident type; shade depth & number = intensity (0 None–4 Severe). State areas are approximated by Voronoi of state centroids clipped to the national boundary — centroid positions are real, cell shapes schematic. Indicative qualitative assessment, not a counted dataset.

Nigeria Activity Heatmap — Incident Type by State (assessed, last ~3 months)
States grouped by geopolitical zone — indicative qualitative assessment as of 2026-09-14, not a counted dataset

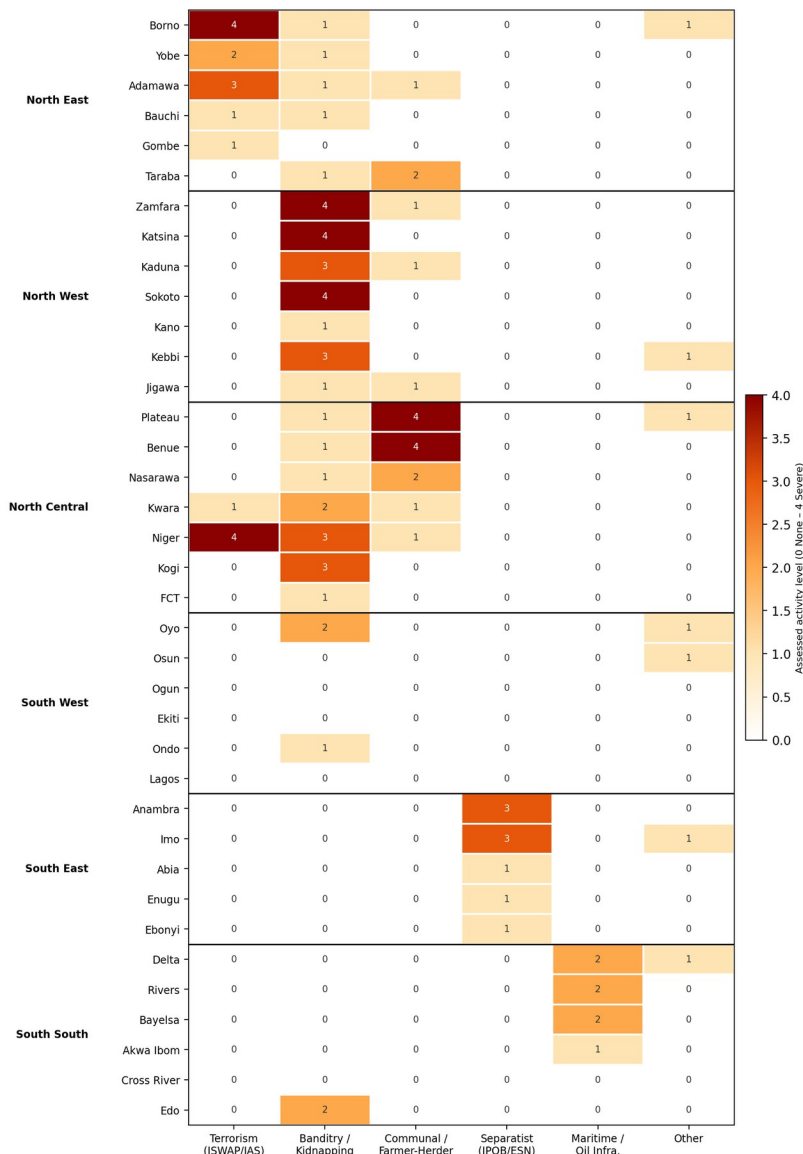


Figure 2 — Incident type by state (states grouped by geopolitical zone). Cell value/shade = assessed activity level, 0 None–4 Severe. Indicative qualitative assessment, not a counted dataset.

6. Events Map — UCDP (curated) & GDELT (news-derived)

Two-panel figure regenerated this morning (14 September; GDELT ingested through 13 September — the scheduled daily map run had not produced today's dated image, so the pipeline was re-run before this brief was built). LEFT PANEL: no new UCDP release has landed for a third consecutive week, so the most recent seven days of curated data remain 25–31 July 2026 — unchanged at 29 events and 174 best-estimate fatalities (57 civilian). The lag is now roughly six and a half weeks; the August candidate release is overdue and will close the gap abruptly when it lands. Read the left panel as verified late-July pattern, not as this week's ground truth. RIGHT PANEL: news-derived GDELT events for the actual last seven days (7 – 13 September 2026: 377 machine-coded events from ~3,465 articles, deduplicated and cross-checked against UCDP) — up from 363 last week, the first rise after two weekly falls, driven by the ceasefire story, the Army reshuffle, Plateau and Benue. GDELT is timely but noisy: locations and event types are machine-extracted and individual dots are not verified incidents; a rising count reflects press attention as much as violence. Cross-referenced against Sections 1–4, expect clusters on the Gwoza/Pulka axis, the Lake Chad islands (Tumbunma

Baba), the Mairari–Gajiram and Damboa corridors, a dense Plateau signature across Jos South, Mangu, Riyom, Barkin Ladi and Bassa, Logo in Benue, Isa and Tambuwal in Sokoto, Tsafe in Zamfara, and a new Edo cluster. Read the panels together: UCDP for verified pattern, GDELT for current tempo and geography.

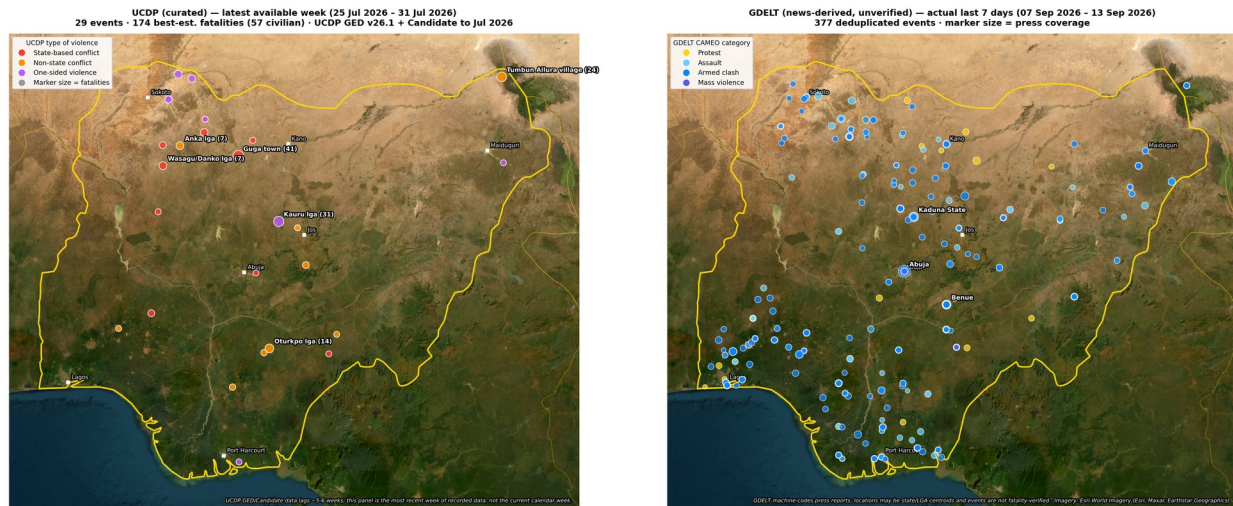


Figure 3 — Left: UCDP-recorded conflict events, most recent 7 days of available curated data (25–31 July 2026; lags ~6½ weeks — NOT current-week ground truth). Right: GDELT news-derived events for 7 – 13 September 2026 — machine-coded from press reporting, deduplicated, unverified; indicative of current reporting tempo only. Rendered 14 September 2026 from the daily-updated Nigeria Events Map.

Interactive map: <https://rbmglobal.co.uk/nigeria-activity-map/>

7. Sources

Open-source reporting consulted 14 September 2026. Military and government figures are flagged as claims throughout. Two-source or better this window: the Pulka base attack (OPHK statement via Vanguard and allAfrica; Zagazola security report — casualty figures differ), the Army repositioning of 9 September (Premium Times, Channels, PRNigeria), the Niger command reshuffle (Al Jazeera/AFP/AP, Zagazola), the Ayilamo attack (Premium Times, Tribune, PM News, The Sun; police-confirmed 11 dead), the Plateau attacks of 13 September (Vanguard, Premium Times, allAfrica — totals differ), the US C-17 delivery (AFRICOM via allAfrica, Vanguard, Zagazola) and the 83 Division status (ThisDay, Nigerian Observer, Zagazola). Single-chain and so labelled: the ceasefire report (The New Humanitarian, republished by Premium Times, Pulse and allAfrica without independent confirmation), the Tumbunma Baba strike figures, the Yankuzo five-aircraft account, and the Zagazola theatre items generally, which other outlets republish rather than corroborate. Recirculated items checked and excluded: a NAN report of NAF strikes on IPOB/ESN hideouts at Mother Valley and Aku Ihube (27 September 2023); the Kebbe Lakurawa raid (mid-August 2026, previously covered); and the February 2026 ISWAP drone-acquisition reporting, which is carried as standing background only.

North East — Pulka, the ceasefire, the air campaign

- [Troops repel Boko Haram/ISWAP attack on base in Borno community \(8 Sep 2026\)](#) — Vanguard (official OPHK statement, Capt Mohammed Goni: ISR then precision strikes on withdrawing attackers; one soldier wounded)
- [Nigeria: Troops Repel Boko Haram/Iswap Attack On Base in Borno Community \(8 Sep 2026\)](#) — allAfrica (republishing of the official account)
- [Troops repel terrorist infiltration attempt on Pulka base, kill one \(10 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (security report: ~22:00 on 7 Sep; one attacker killed, two soldiers wounded, three MRAP tyres damaged; 26 TF Bde Garrison reinforcement)

- [Troops stand firm, repel ISWAP attack on Pulka in Borno \(8 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (same chain as the official statement)
- [EXCLUSIVE: Nigerian government and Boko Haram strike secret ceasefire deal \(7 Sep 2026\)](#) — *The New Humanitarian* (three sources; truce since June linked to the Ngoshe release; ISWAP excluded; government no comment; 'equipment into the Mandara mountains' warning)
- [Nigerian government reportedly enters secret ceasefire agreement with Boko Haram \(8 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Premium Times* (republishing; Bakura Doro faction named)
- [Airstrikes destroy terrorist logistics hubs, neutralise 18 in Tumbunma Baba \(11 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (06:05 on 11 Sep after ISR on 9 Sep; ~18 claimed; 85% assessed; further interdiction recommended — single chain)
- [Troops kill 18 terrorists, destroy logistics hubs in Borno \(Sep 2026\)](#) — *Vanguard* (republishing of the same figures)
- [Troops foil terrorist IED attack along Mairari–Gajiram road in Borno \(8 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (two command-detonated IEDs, 09:45 on 5 Sep; no casualties; garrison reinforcement)
- [Troops discover, detonate terrorist-planted IED along Damboa-Bulabulin road \(8 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola
- [Troops foil Boko Haram ambush, dismantle makeshift camps in Borno \(7 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (27 Task Force Bde, Buni Gari–Buratai axis, Bui)
- [Two minors escape terrorist enclave, surrender to troops in Gwoza \(13 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Mandara Mountains enclave)
- [Troops rescue eight abductees, including children, in Gwoza \(13 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Gwoza East corridor, two operations)
- [Troops rescue woman, daughter after escape from terrorist camp in Borno \(10 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (82 Div Task Force Bn)
- [Four terrorist family members surrender to troops in Borno \(8 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (192 Bn (M), Gwoza–Limankara road, 7 Sep)
- [Troops receive surrendered suspected terrorist member from CDF in Borno \(10 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (152 TF Bn, Banki; handover from Chadian Defence Forces)
- [Troops arrest two suspected terrorists' collaborators with ₦3.65m in Monguno \(13 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola
- [Troops arrest suspected ISWAP informant, recover ID card, drugs in Borno \(10 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Sector 3, Monguno)
- [Troops intercept 11 empty CNG cylinders, open-loop kit in Borno \(8 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (233 Tank Bn; pressure vessels without clearance — precursor watch)
- [Troops arrest three suspected terrorist logistics suppliers in Borno \(13 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Konduga LGA)
- [Troops arrest suspected terrorist fighter in Kukawa \(13 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (returnee from the Lake Chad axis)
- [Troops arrest suspected terrorist logistics supplier with 64 rolls of clothing material in Adamawa \(8 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (247 Recce Bn)

Command, air, ISR & force protection

- [Nigerian Army redeploys top generals, appoints new person to lead Boko Haram war \(9 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Premium Times* (full Army statement: Maj Gen I. A. Ajose to OPHK Theatre Command; Brig Gen M. S. Sule to 27 TF Bde; Brig Gen I. Sule to 6 Div Garrison; Brig Gen M. S. Adamu to newly established 8 Bde)
- [Army Redeploys Senior Officers, Appoints New Theatre Commander \(9 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Channels* (independent chain)

- [U.S. Air Force C-17 delivers military equipment to Nigerian Air Force under FMS agreement \(10 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (AFRICOM announcement)
- [Nigeria: U.S. Announces New Delivery of Defence Equipment to Nigeria \(11 Sep 2026\)](#) — allAfrica (delivery to the NAF at Lagos and Kainji)
- [AFRICOM leaders highlight defense innovation at NDIA conference \(9 Sep 2026\)](#) — AFRICOM (DICON DG Maj Gen Babatunde Alaya on panel; no new Nigeria strike announcements)
- [Police Air Wing eliminates nine bandits, destroys camps, recovers arms in North-West \(13 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (police statement; rocket launcher with warheads and three PKMs recovered; Katsina and Jangebe, Zamfara)
- [Military Airstrikes hit suspected terrorist hideout in Zamfara, several fighters killed \(8 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (local sources: five aircraft over Yankuzo, Tsafe, evening of 7 Sep — unverified)
- [Troops repel simultaneous terrorist attacks in Sokoto \(7 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (FOB Tidibale and village, Isa LGA, 00:10 on 6 Sep; two gun trucks burned after fuel-tank hits)
- [Nigeria loses CH-4 drone \(Jan 2026 — standing reference, NOT current\)](#) — Military Africa (last confirmed airframe loss)
- [ISWAP terrorists acquire more drones, plan coordinated attacks on Nigerian troops \(Feb 2026 — standing background\)](#) — Premium Times (~35 drones; unemployed to date)
- [AI helps terror groups plan, execute attacks \(Sep 2026\)](#) — Africa Defense Forum (ISWAP technological adaptation — background)

Regional — Niger, Mali, Chad

- [Niger military government reshuffles army command weeks after deadly mutiny \(13 Sep 2026\)](#) — Al Jazeera/AFP/AP (Kiaou replaces Barmou; Zataka army chief; ex-Base 101 commander Sidi Omar deputy chief of staff)
- [After Barmou: Is Niger shifting from a counter-terrorism army to a regime-protection force? \(13 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola analysis (implications for the Nigeria–Niger seam)
- [Dioura falls as Mali's security crisis spreads south while Kati tightens its grip \(13 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola analysis
- [Sudan war spills into Chad, Nigeria emerges as critical buffer against widening Sahel insecurity \(8 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola analysis

North West & Middle Belt

- [Insecurity: Protest in Sokoto over kidnappings, attacks \(11 Sep 2026\)](#) — Vanguard (Tambuwal LGA; roads closed)
- [One Shot, Others Injured As Sokoto Residents Protest Renewed Bandit Attacks \(11 Sep 2026\)](#) — Naija News (independent chain; injury claim single-source)
- [Troops raid suspected Lakurawa motorcycle repair workshop in Sokoto \(12 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (8 Guards Task Force, FOB Kware)
- [Troops arrest terrorist kingpin, ammunition courier, logistics supplier in Kaduna \(10 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (JTF North West)
- [Troops rescue 12 kidnapped victims, foil abduction attempts in Zamfara \(8 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Kaura Namoda and Tsafe)
- [Troops rescue four kidnapped victims after gunmen attack vehicle in Katsina \(13 Sep 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Ruwan Godiya axis, Faskari)
- [Army denies abduction of Islamic clerics from Senator Yari's residence \(14 Sep 2026\)](#) — Premium Times (Zamfara; information-environment item)

- [Bandits kill four police officers, seven civilians in Benue attack \(11 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Premium Times* (Ayilamo, Logo LGA, 10 Sep; police-confirmed)
- [Benue: Four policemen, eight residents killed in Logo community attack \(11 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Tribune* (independent chain; civilian count one higher)
- [Gov Alia Commends DSS For Apprehending Ayilamo Attackers, Commiserates with Victims \(11 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (three suspects arrested)
- [Gunmen kill 13, injure many in fresh Plateau attacks \(14 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Vanguard* (Dungus, Jos South vehicle attack; Mangu; Riyom — highest reported total)
- [Four killed in fresh Plateau attacks \(14 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Premium Times* (lower total for the same night)
- [Mwaghavul Militia Killed Three herders, Slaughter 36 cattle in unprovoked attack in Plateau \(12 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (Alohom, Mangu; other outlets report 50 cattle)
- [Troops engage suspected local militias, soldier wounded during clearance operation in Plateau \(10 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (Kogul, Mangu)
- [Berom Militia attack herders in Plateau, kill fulani herders, shot seven livestock and rustle dozens \(9 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (Jong–Nyeriwei road; GOC 3 Div visit followed)

South East, South South, South West & national

- [AHQ committee visits Delta communities over proposed establishment of 83 Division \(9 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (63 Bde Asaba; two proposed sites inspected 7 Sep)
- [Okpebholo assures speedy operationalisation of 83 Division in Edo \(Sep 2026\)](#) — *Nigerian Observer* (temporary facility in Benin City promised within two weeks)
- [New Nigerian Army Divisions, Bold Reforms and the Contiguity Question \(10 Aug 2026\)](#) — *ThisDay* (83 Div HQ Benin City covering Edo, Delta, Bayelsa; expected by Dec 2026)
- [Troops arrest suspected kidnapper, recover AK-47 rifle in Edo \(12 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (4 Bde, Op Whirl Punch / Op Rescue, Ikpoba-Okha)
- [Troops raid suspected kidnappers' hideout, recover clothing, food items in Edo \(10 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (Op MESA, Akoko-Edo)
- [Troops rescue kidnapped victim in Edo \(9 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (322 Army Regt, Ekpoma)
- [Naval officer, driver arrested with 248 moulds of suspected cannabis in Rivers \(7 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (internal discipline)
- [Troops arrest five suspected drug peddlers in Delta \(6 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (90 Amphibious Bn with NDLEA, Sapele)
- [Adeleke bans NURTW activities in Osun after ally shot dead, orders probe \(14 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Premium Times* (South West political violence watch)
- [Investigation begins as SNCO dies after shooting incident at Kuje custodial centre \(7 Sep 2026\)](#) — *Zagazola* (FCT)

Annex A — State Governors, Ethnic Affiliation & Principal Army Formations

Standing annex — changes since the 7 September issue are summarised here. NO GUBERNATORIAL CHANGES and NO DEFECTIONS. ONE THEATRE COMMAND CHANGE, the most significant annex item in some weeks: on 9 September the COAS, Lt Gen Waidi Shaibu, approved a repositioning under which Maj Gen I. A. Ajose (from AHQ Department of Army Operations) becomes Theatre Commander JTF North East / Operation HADIN KAI, replacing Maj Gen A. E. Abubakar, who moves to the Nigerian Army Heritage and Future Centre as Dean, Faculty

of Operational Research. At brigade and garrison level in the same release: Brig Gen M. S. Sule (from Special Task Force Op ENDURING PEACE) commands 27 Task Force Brigade (Biu, Borno); Brig Gen I. Sule commands 6 Division Garrison (Port Harcourt), replacing Brig Gen A. A. Bello, who leaves 6 Div Garrison / Sector 3 JTF South-South for DHQ Operations; Brig Gen E. Azenda commands 2 Division Garrison (Ibadan), replacing Brig Gen A. S. Bugaje; and Brig Gen M. S. Adamu commands a NEWLY ESTABLISHED 8 BRIGADE whose location and parent division are not stated in the release — watch. The July 2026 divisional slate (Maj Gen Yakubu Yahaya, 9 Div Ilorin; Maj Gen C. R. Nnebeife, 10 Div Jalingo; Maj Gen Moses Gara, 5 Div Makurdi; Maj Gen Auwalu Mahmuda, 2 Div Ibadan; Maj Gen A. S. M. Wase, 1 Div Kaduna) is otherwise unchanged. ONE CORRECTION to last week's correction: 83 Division is APPROVED, NOT YET ESTABLISHED. It was approved in July 2026 as one of four new divisions, with headquarters designated for Benin City and an AOR of Edo, Delta and Bayelsa and an expected stand-up by December 2026; the Edo government has promised a temporary facility in Benin City within two weeks, while an Army Headquarters committee visited 63 Brigade in Asaba and traditional rulers in Oshimili North on 7 September to inspect two proposed sites for the division's units — Delta is lobbying for a share of the formation. Last week's entry describing 83 Div as established in Benin City was premature; the Edo and Delta rows below are corrected. FORMATION-COLUMN UPDATES, all additive and drawn from units named in this week's engagements: Borno (26 TF Bde Garrison — Pulka reinforcement; FOB Pulka; 152 TF Bn, Banki; 192 Bn (M), Gwoza–Limankara; 233 Tank Bn; 27 TF Bde now under Brig Gen M. S. Sule); Adamawa (247 Recce Bn); Sokoto (8 Guards Task Force at FOB Kware and FOB Denge Shuni; 8 Div Garrison at FOB Tidibale and FOB Ghandi, Isa LGA); Zamfara (1 Bde FOB Sabon-Gari, Kaura Namoda); Kogi (12 Bde, Irekpeni Patrol Base, Adavi); Nasarawa (177 Guards Bn, FOB Mararaba Udege); Edo (4 Bde under Op WHIRL PUNCH / Op RESCUE; 322 Army Regt, Ekpoma; Op MESA in Akoko-Edo); Delta (63 Bde = HQ Sector 1 JTF South-South Op DELTA SAFE, Comd Brig Gen I. B. Buhari; 90 Amphibious Bn, Sapele); Rivers (new 6 Div Garrison commander); Oyo (new 2 Div Garrison commander). The Plateau OPEP / Op SAFE HAVEN naming overlap persisted this week (7 September items filed under Op SAFE HAVEN, later items under OPEP, same sectors) and the caution stands.

State	Governor	Party (changes)	Ethnic affiliation (as publicly reported)	Principal Army formation(s) in state (indicative)
NORTH EAST				
Borno	Babagana Umara Zulum	APC	Kanuri	HQ 7 Div & OPHK Theatre Comd (Maiduguri) — NEW THEATRE COMMANDER: Maj Gen I. A. Ajose (from AHQ Dept of Army Operations), appointed 9 Sep 2026, replacing Maj Gen A. E. Abubakar; OPHK Sector 3 (Kukawa/Monguno) incl. 101 Special Forces Bn; 212 Bn (Jere); 115 Task Force Bn (Askira-Uba); 29 Task Force Bde; 154 Task Force Bn (Ngamdu, Kaga); 25 Bde (Damboa); 82 Div Task Force Bn (Gwoza); 27 Task Force Bde (Biu) — NEW Comd Brig Gen M. S. Sule (9 Sep); NEW this issue: 26 Task Force Bde Garrison (reinforced FOB Pulka), 192 Bn (M) (Gwoza–Limankara), 152 Task Force Bn (Banki), 233 Tank Bn; 81 Div Task Force Bn attached; MNJTF Sector 3 (Baga); NAF air component OPHK (Maiduguri) — WATCH:

State	Governor	Party (changes)	Ethnic affiliation (as publicly reported)	Principal Army formation(s) in state (indicative)
				FOB Pulka / Mandara axis after the 7 Sep night infiltration attempt; Mairari–Gajiram MSR command-detonated IEDs 5 Sep; reported JAS ceasefire area (Ngoshe/Mandara) — strike-authority question open
Yobe	Mai Mala Buni	APC	Kanuri	OPHK Sector 2 (Damaturu); 120 Task Force Bn (Gujba); 159 Bn (Geidam); task-force brigade elements (Buni Yadi axis)
Adamawa	Ahmadu Umaru Fintiri	APC (defected from PDP, Feb 2026)	Northern-Adamawa minority (Madagali axis); identification varies in public reporting	23 Bde (Yola); OPHK Sector 4 (Adamawa) with newly inducted 226 Bn, operating with an Office of the NSA tactical team; NEW: 247 Recce Bn (stop-and-search logistics intercept). WATCH: Hong / Kopre Mountain / Mandara-fringe axis as a JAS rear area and suspected hostage-holding area
Bauchi	Bala Mohammed	PDP (opposition)	Fulani	33 Artillery Bde (Shadawanka Barracks, Bauchi)
Gombe	Muhammadu Inuwa Yahaya	APC	Fulani	Rear-area/support elements to OPHK
Taraba	Agbu Kefas	APC (defection from PDP announced for Jan 2026)	Jukun	HQ 10 Div (Jalingo) — activated Jul 2026, GOC Maj Gen C. R. Nnebeife; 6 Bde (Jalingo); Op Whirl Stroke elements
NORTH WEST				
Kaduna	Uba Sani	APC	Hausa/Fulani	HQ 1 Div (Kaduna) — NEW: GOC named, Maj Gen Abubakar Sadique Muhammed Wase, 44th GOC and dual-hatted Comd Sector 1 JTF Op Fansan Yamma (in post since Aug 2025; previously unnamed in this annex); Nigerian Defence Academy; major NAF bases (Kaduna); 44 Nigerian Army Reference Hospital — helipad and Waidi Shaibu Critical Care Centre commissioned 25 Aug 2026 for air CASEVAC of wounded
Kano	Abba Kabir Yusuf	APC (defected from NNPP, 26 Jan 2026)	Hausa/Fulani	3 Bde (Kano)
Katsina	Dikko Umaru Radda	APC	Fulani	17 Bde (Katsina) — Op Fansan Yamma
Kebbi	Nasir Idris	APC	Fulani (Kauran Gwandu)	Elements under 8 Div AOR (Birnin Kebbi garrison)
Sokoto	Ahmed Aliyu	APC	Hausa/Fulani	HQ 8 Div (Sokoto) — Op Fansan Yamma; 28 Special Forces Bde (FOB Sifawa, FOB Shagari); 8

State	Governor	Party (changes)	Ethnic affiliation (as publicly reported)	Principal Army formation(s) in state (indicative)
				Div Strike Team; COAS Intervention Bn 7 and 8 Task Force Group Administration Bn under Sector 2 OPFY; NEW: 8 Guards Task Force (FOB Kware; FOB Denge Shuni — Lakurawa counter-logistics); 8 Div Garrison elements at FOB Tidibale and FOB Ghandi, Isa LGA — WATCH: simultaneous night attacks on FOB Tidibale and village 6 Sep, two gun trucks burned; Tambuwal insecurity protest 11 Sep
Zamfara	Dauda Lawal	APC (defected from PDP, Mar 2026)	Hausa	1 Bde (Gusau) incl. FOB Sabon-Gari (Kaura Namoda); OPFY Sector 2; NAF and Police Air Wing air operations (Yankuzo/Tsafe 7 Sep; Jangebe axis)
Jigawa	Umar Namadi	APC	Hausa/Fulani	Elements under 3 Bde (Kano) AOR
NORTH CENTRAL				
Plateau	Caleb Mutfwang	APC (defected from PDP, late 2025)	Mwaghavul	HQ 3 Armoured Div (Jos); Op ENDURING PEACE (OPEP) — Comd Maj Gen W. M. Dangana, sectors numbered 1–8 with sub-sectors; Special Task Force OPEP (Brig Gen M. S. Sule departed 9 Sep to 27 TF Bde — successor not yet named); CAUTION (persists): reporting uses OPEP and Op SAFE HAVEN interchangeably for the same sectors — treat the two names as one AOR when routing a request; state-level Op Rainbow alongside
Benue	Hyacinth Alia	APC	Tiv	HQ 5 Div (Makurdi) — GOC Maj Gen Moses Gara, dual-hatted Comd Op Whirl Stroke (Jul 2026); OPWS Sector 2 (Guma); 11 Bde (Gboko); 72 Special Forces Bn (Makurdi); Operation Zenda (state-level); NAF Tactical Air Command HQ (Makurdi) — WATCH: Ayilamo, Logo LGA attacked again 10 Sep, 4 MOPOL and 7 civilians killed
Niger	Mohammed Umaru Bago	APC	Nupe	31 Artillery Bde (Minna); Army TRADOC (Minna); 29 Bde (Kainji) — WATCH: Lakurawa operational leadership assessed by ISS to be based in Borgu LGA; Op Savannah Shield active in Mariga LGA this week
Kwara	AbdulRahman AbdulRazaq	APC	Yoruba (Ilorin)	HQ 9 Div (Ilorin) — GOC Maj Gen Yakubu Yahaya,

State	Governor	Party (changes)	Ethnic affiliation (as publicly reported)	Principal Army formation(s) in state (indicative)
				dual-hatted Comd Op Savannah Shield (Jul 2026); Sobi Barracks garrison
Kogi	Ahmed Usman Ododo	APC	Ebira	Garrison elements (Lokoja); NEW: 12 Bde (Irekpeni Patrol Base, Adavi LGA); confluence-axis security ops; joint ops under 2 Div AOR (western Kogi)
Nasarawa	Abdullahi Sule	APC	Hausa	10 Bde (Lafia); NEW: 177 Guards Bn (FOB Mararaba Udege); Op Whirl Stroke elements (Lafia axis)
FCT Abuja	— (administered by FCT Minister Nyesom Wike)	APC-aligned (Wike ex-PDP)	Ikwerre (minister)	Guards Bde (Abuja); Defence HQ & Service HQs; NAF HQ
SOUTH EAST				
Abia	Alex Otti	Labour Party (opposition)	Igbo	14 Bde (Ohafia); 144 Bn (Aba South)
Anambra	Charles Soludo (re-elected Nov 2025)	APGA (opposition, APC-aligned)	Igbo	302 Artillery Regt (Onitsha); 15 Bde — established Jul 2026 under JTF South East / Op UDO KA; led the 15 and 22 Aug Anambra camp raids
Ebonyi	Francis Nwifuru	APC	Igbo	Elements under 82 Div AOR (Abakaliki); 24 Special Engineer Regt
Enugu	Peter Mbah	APC (defected from PDP)	Igbo	HQ 82 Composite Div (Enugu)
Imo	Hope Uzodinma	APC	Igbo	34 Artillery Bde (Obinze, Owerri) — WATCH: first anti-armour IED against troops in the SE inside the window, detonated under an MRAP on the Ihite Ukwa–Health Centre axis, Orsu LGA, 4 Sep; Orsu sits on the Imo–Anambra ESN seam next to the Ihiala axis
SOUTH SOUTH				
Rivers	Siminalayi Fubara (reinstated Sep 2025 after emergency rule)	APC (reported defection from PDP, Dec 2025)	Ijaw (Opobo/Nkoro)	HQ 6 Div (Port Harcourt); 6 Div Garrison — NEW Comd Brig Gen I. Sule (9 Sep), replacing Brig Gen A. A. Bello (to DHQ Operations); JTF Op Delta Safe (Sector 3); NNS Pathfinder
Bayelsa	Douye Diri	APC (defected from PDP, 2025)	Ijaw	16 Bde (Yenagoa)
Delta	Sheriff Oborevwori	APC (defected from PDP, May 2025)	Okpe (Urhobo)	63 Bde (Asaba) = HQ Sector 1 JTF South-South Op DELTA SAFE, Comd Brig Gen I. B. Buhari; 90 Amphibious Bn (Sapele); AHQ committee inspected two proposed sites for 83 Div units in Oshimili North on 7 Sep — Delta lobbying for the formation
Edo	Monday Okpebholo	APC	Esan	CORRECTED: 83 Div —

State	Governor	Party (changes)	Ethnic affiliation (as publicly reported)	Principal Army formation(s) in state (indicative)
	(elected Sep 2024)			APPROVED Jul 2026, NOT YET ESTABLISHED; HQ designated Benin City, AOR Edo/Delta/Bayelsa, expected stand-up by Dec 2026; temporary facility in Benin City promised within two weeks (Sep 2026). 4 Bde (Benin City) — Op WHIRL PUNCH / Op RESCUE; 322 Army Regt (Ekpoma); Op MESA (Akoko-Edo forest belt) — Edo 1 – 2 on the heatmap this issue
Akwa Ibom	Umo Eno	APC (defected from PDP, 2025)	Ibibio	2 Bde (Uyo)
Cross River	Bassey Otu	APC	Efik	13 Bde (Calabar); Navy Eastern Command (Calabar) — anti-piracy / oil-theft offensive announced 21 Aug 2026, continuing
SOUTH WEST				
Lagos	Babajide Sanwo-Olu	APC	Yoruba	HQ 81 Div (Lagos); Navy Western Command
Ogun	Dapo Abiodun	APC	Yoruba	Elements under 81 Div AOR
Oyo	Seyi Makinde	PDP (opposition)	Yoruba	HQ 2 Div (Ibadan) — GOC Maj Gen Auwalu Mahmuda (Jul 2026); 2 Div Garrison — NEW Comd Brig Gen E. Azenda (9 Sep), replacing Brig Gen A. S. Bugaje
Osun	Ademola Adeleke (re-elected 15 Aug 2026 — second term)	Accord Party — left PDP Dec 2025; re-elected 15 Aug 2026 with 511,067 votes vs APC 444,815; an APC-defection rumour was denied by his camp in late August	Yoruba	Elements under 2 Div AOR
Ondo	Lucky Aiyedatiwa (elected Nov 2024)	APC	Yoruba (Ilaje)	32 Artillery Bde (Akure/Owena)
Ekiti	Biodun Oyebanji	APC	Yoruba	Elements under 2 Div AOR (Ado-Ekiti garrison)

Changes to watch: the OPHK command changeover is the item that matters most to us — a new theatre commander will re-examine strike authorities, ISR priorities and the balance between the Lake Chad, Sambisa and Mandara axes, and the reported JAS ceasefire will be the first hard policy question on his desk. Watch for where the new 8 Brigade stands up and under which division. The 83 Division siting contest between Edo and Delta will determine where a new divisional headquarters, and eventually its aviation support requirement, appears on the western Niger Delta seam by year-end. Carried forward: the western corridor (29 Bde Kainji and 9 Div Ilorin, ten weeks old, with Lakurawa leadership assessed to sit in Borgu); the Hong / Kopre Mountain axis in Adamawa as a JAS rear area and suspected hostage-holding area; the Osun governor's party position and the Bauchi governor's defection rumours as the 2027 cycle warms; and the Plateau naming overlap for routing requests.

Reminder: This is open-source orientation only and is not a substitute for current in-theatre intelligence. Verify all specifics against your unit's authoritative reporting before acting on them operationally.